

IDS11072
Australian Government Bureau of Meteorology
South Australia

Coastal Waters Forecast for South Australia

Issued at 9:30 am CDT on Tuesday 6 October 2026
for the period until midnight CDT Thursday 8 October 2026.

Please be aware

Wind and wave forecasts are averages. Wind gusts can be 40 per cent stronger than the forecast, and stronger still in squalls and thunderstorms. Maximum waves can be twice the forecast height.

Warning Information

For latest warnings go to www.bom.gov.au, subscribe to RSS feeds, call 1300 659 210* or listen for warnings on relevant TV and radio broadcasts.

Weather Situation

A high pressure system southwest of SA extends a ridge over much of the state, as a cold front clips the southeast early Tuesday. The high will quickly move in behind the front and maintain a ridge over SA as it moves to the east of Tasmania by Thursday. A strong cold front is then expected move into the Bight later on Thursday and move east across the rest of SA on Friday and early Saturday.

Far West Coast: WA-SA Border to Fowlers Bay

Forecast for Tuesday 6 October until midnight

Winds: South to southeasterly 10 to 15 knots tending east to southeasterly during the afternoon and evening.
Seas: Around 1 metre. Swell: Southwesterly 2.5 to 3 metres. Weather: Partly cloudy.

Forecast for Wednesday 7 October

Winds: Easterly 15 to 20 knots. Seas: Around 1 metre, increasing to 1 to 1.5 metres offshore. Swell: Southwesterly 2.5 to 3 metres. Weather: Mostly sunny.

Forecast for Thursday 8 October

Winds: North to northeasterly 15 to 25 knots shifting west to southwesterly 15 to 20 knots during the afternoon. Seas: 1 to 1.5 metres, decreasing below 1 metre during the evening. Swell: Southwesterly 2 to 2.5 metres. Weather: Mostly sunny morning. The chance of a thunderstorm in the afternoon and evening.

Upper West Coast: Fowlers Bay to Elliston

Forecast for Tuesday 6 October until midnight

Winds: Southerly 10 to 15 knots turning southeasterly in the late afternoon. Seas: Below 1 metre. Swell: Southwesterly 2.5 to 3 metres. Weather: Partly cloudy.

Forecast for Wednesday 7 October

Winds: Northeast to southeasterly 10 to 15 knots becoming variable about 10 knots in the middle of the day then becoming south to southeasterly 10 to 15 knots in the evening. Seas: Below 1 metre. Swell: Southwesterly 2.5 to 3 metres. Weather: Mostly sunny.

Forecast for Thursday 8 October

Winds: East to northeasterly 10 to 15 knots turning north to northwesterly 15 to 20 knots during the day. Seas: Around 1 metre, increasing to 1 to 1.5 metres during the morning. Swell: Southwesterly 2 to 3 metres. Weather: Becoming cloudy. 70% chance of showers. The chance of a thunderstorm in the evening.

Lower West Coast: Elliston to Cape Carnot

Forecast for Tuesday 6 October until midnight

Winds: South to southwesterly 10 to 15 knots turning southeasterly in the late afternoon. Seas: Around 1 metre. Swell: Southwesterly 2.5 to 3 metres inshore, increasing to 3 to 4 metres offshore. Weather: Partly cloudy.

Forecast for Wednesday 7 October

Winds: Easterly 10 to 15 knots becoming variable about 10 knots in the middle of the day. Seas: Below 1 metre. Swell: Southwesterly 2.5 to 3 metres inshore, increasing to 3 to 4 metres offshore. Weather: Cloud clearing.

Forecast for Thursday 8 October

Winds: Northeasterly 15 to 20 knots tending northerly during the morning then tending northwesterly during the evening. Seas: Below 1 metre, increasing to 1 to 1.5 metres during the morning. Swell: Southwesterly 2.5 to 3 metres. Weather: Becoming cloudy. 60% chance of showers. The chance of a thunderstorm in the evening.

Central Coast

Forecast for Tuesday 6 October until midnight

Winds: South to southwesterly 15 to 20 knots tending south to southeasterly 10 to 15 knots in the middle of the day then tending east to southeasterly in the late evening. Seas: Around 1 metre. Swell: Southwesterly 3 metres, increasing to 3 to 4 metres around midday. Weather: Partly cloudy.

Forecast for Wednesday 7 October

Winds: Easterly 15 to 20 knots. Seas: Around 1 metre. Swell: Southwesterly 3 to 4 metres, decreasing to 3 metres around midday. Weather: Cloud clearing.

Forecast for Thursday 8 October

Winds: Northeasterly 15 to 20 knots turning northerly during the day. Seas: Below 1 metre, increasing to 1 to 1.5 metres during the morning. Swell: Southwesterly 2.5 to 3 metres. Weather: Mostly sunny. 50% chance of showers. The chance of a thunderstorm in the evening.

South Central Coast

Forecast for Tuesday 6 October until midnight

Winds: South to southwesterly 15 to 20 knots turning southeasterly 10 to 15 knots during the afternoon and evening. Seas: 1 to 1.5 metres, decreasing below 1 metre during the afternoon. Swell: Southwesterly 3 to 4 metres. Weather: Partly cloudy.

Forecast for Wednesday 7 October

Winds: East to southeasterly 10 to 15 knots tending east to northeasterly 15 to 20 knots early in the morning. Seas: Around 1 metre, increasing to 1 to 1.5 metres during the morning, then decreasing to 1 metre during the afternoon. Swell: Southwesterly 3 to 4 metres, decreasing to 3 metres by early evening. Weather: Cloud clearing.

Forecast for Thursday 8 October

Winds: North to northeasterly 15 to 20 knots. Seas: Around 1 metre, increasing to 1 to 1.5 metres during the morning. Swell: Southwesterly 2.5 to 3 metres. Weather: Sunny.

Upper South East Coast: Murray Mouth to Cape Jaffa

Forecast for Tuesday 6 October until midnight

Winds: Southwesterly 15 to 20 knots turning south to southeasterly 10 to 15 knots in the afternoon. Seas: 1.5 metres, decreasing to 1 metre during the afternoon. Swell: Southwesterly 3 metres, increasing to 3 to 4 metres around midday. Weather: Partly cloudy.

Forecast for Wednesday 7 October

Winds: East to southeasterly 10 to 15 knots tending east to northeasterly in the early morning then tending east to southeasterly in the late afternoon. Winds reaching up to 20 knots offshore during the morning. Seas: Around 1 metre. Swell: Southwesterly 3 to 4 metres, decreasing to 3 metres by early evening. Weather: Sunny.

Forecast for Thursday 8 October

Winds: Northeasterly 15 to 20 knots. Seas: Around 1 metre, increasing to 1 to 1.5 metres offshore during the morning. Swell: Southwesterly 2.5 to 3 metres. Weather: Sunny.

Lower South East Coast: Cape Jaffa to SA-VIC Border

Forecast for Tuesday 6 October until midnight

Winds: Southwesterly 15 to 20 knots, reaching up to 25 knots south of Beachport in the late morning. Winds turning south to southeasterly 10 to 15 knots in the late afternoon. Seas: 1 to 2 metres, decreasing to 1 metre by early evening. Swell: Southwesterly 4 metres. Weather: Partly cloudy.

Forecast for Wednesday 7 October

Winds: East to southeasterly 10 to 15 knots tending east to northeasterly in the early morning then tending east to southeasterly in the late afternoon. Winds reaching up to 20 knots south of Port MacDonnell in the evening. Seas: Around 1 metre. Swell: Southwesterly 4 metres. Weather: Partly cloudy.

Forecast for Thursday 8 October

Winds: East to northeasterly 15 to 20 knots tending north to northeasterly during the morning. Seas: Around 1 metre, increasing to 1 to 1.5 metres offshore. Swell: Southwesterly 3 to 4 metres, decreasing to 2.5 to 3 metres during the morning. Weather: Sunny.

Spencer Gulf

Forecast for Tuesday 6 October until midnight

Winds: Southwesterly 10 to 15 knots turning southeasterly 15 to 20 knots during the afternoon and evening. Seas: Around 1 metre, increasing to 1 to 1.5 metres north of Cowell to Wallaroo during the afternoon. Swell: South to southwesterly 1 to 1.5 metres, increasing to 1 to 2 metres during the afternoon. Weather: Partly cloudy.

Forecast for Wednesday 7 October

Winds: Southeasterly 15 to 20 knots turning easterly early in the morning. Seas: 1 to 1.5 metres, decreasing below 1 metre during the morning. Swell: South to southwesterly around 1 metre, increasing to 1 to 2 metres south of Cowell to Wallaroo. Weather: Sunny.

Forecast for Thursday 8 October

Winds: Easterly 10 to 15 knots tending northeasterly 15 to 20 knots during the morning then tending northerly during the evening. Seas: Around 1 metre, increasing to 1 to 1.5 metres south of Cowell to Wallaroo during the morning. Swell: South to southwesterly around 1 metre, increasing to 1 to 2 metres south of Cowell to Wallaroo. Weather: Sunny.

Gulf St Vincent

Forecast for Tuesday 6 October until midnight

Winds: West to southwesterly 10 to 15 knots turning south to southeasterly 15 to 20 knots in the early afternoon. Seas: Around 1 metre, increasing to 1 to 1.5 metres north of Port Vincent to Brighton during the afternoon. Swell: South to southwesterly below 1 metre. Weather: Partly cloudy.

Forecast for Wednesday 7 October

Winds: Northeast to southeasterly 10 to 15 knots tending northeasterly in the morning then tending northeast to southeasterly in the middle of the day. Seas: Around 1 metre. Swell: Southeast to southwesterly below 1 metre. Weather: Sunny.

Forecast for Thursday 8 October

Winds: Northeasterly 15 to 20 knots tending northwest to northeasterly 10 to 15 knots during the afternoon then becoming northeasterly 15 to 20 knots during the evening. Seas: Around 1 metre, increasing to 1 to 1.5 metres south of Port Vincent to Brighton. Swell: West to southwesterly below 0.5 metres. Weather: Sunny.

Investigator Strait

Forecast for Tuesday 6 October until midnight

Winds: Southwesterly 10 to 15 knots, reaching up to 20 knots through the Backstairs Passage in the late morning. Winds turning southeasterly in the late afternoon. Seas: Around 1 metre. Swell: West to southwesterly 1 to 1.5 metres, increasing to 1 to 2 metres inshore. Weather: Partly cloudy.

Forecast for Wednesday 7 October

Winds: Southeasterly 10 to 15 knots turning easterly before dawn. Winds reaching up to 20 knots through the Backstairs Passage during the morning. Seas: Around 1 metre. Swell: West to southwesterly 1 to 1.5 metres. Weather: Sunny.

Forecast for Thursday 8 October

Winds: East to northeasterly 10 to 15 knots tending north to northeasterly 15 to 20 knots during the morning. Seas: Below 1 metre, increasing to 1 to 1.5 metres during the morning. Swell: West to southwesterly 1 to 1.5 metres, decreasing to around 1 metre during the morning. Weather: Sunny.

The next routine forecast will be issued at 3:30 pm CDT Tuesday.

* Calls to 1300 numbers cost around 27.5c incl. GST, higher from mobiles or public phones. Marine forecasts are also available on VHF and HF radio. View the radio schedule on www.bom.gov.au/marine

Check the latest Coastal Waters Forecasts for information on wind, wave and weather conditions for neighbouring coastal zones.
--